

Coaching Muhammad — Where He Actually Is, and the Plan to Make Him Dangerous

For Spencer - both calls graded, and the six-session plan

For: Spencer · **Date:** 2026-08-04 **Basis:** both of Muhammad's role-play calls today — his first two mole calls ever.

Read this first: he is further along than the scores suggest

I graded call #1 against Spencer-with-twenty-years. That's the wrong benchmark for someone's first call, and it produced a debrief that reads like a list of failures. Here's the honest read.

Call #1 — 2026-08-04 15:22, 7m18s, Spencer as an Enumclaw new homeowner → **63/100** **Call #2** — 2026-08-04 16:07, 6m10s, Cory as an unsure price-shopper in Buckley → **70/100**

Forty-five minutes apart. And this is the part that matters:

Three of the four things I flagged in call #1, he fixed in call #2 — with nobody having told him.

Flagged in call #1	Call #2
Never asked "how long have you been dealing with the moles?"	Asked it — and stopped himself mid-pitch to do it: <i>"But before I go forward, let me ask you how long it's been going on."</i>
Never asked residential vs commercial	Asked it , and tied it to the price tier out loud
Never asked "how did you find us?"	Asked it before hanging up
Capture collapsed to a first name	Name, phone, address, email — all four

Someone who self-corrects that fast between reps is not a training problem. He is coachable at a rate that's genuinely unusual, and everything below assumes that.

What he already does that you cannot teach

- 1. Tone.** Both calls. Warm, unhurried, never defensive under price pressure. This is the hardest part of phone sales and he arrived with it.
- 2. He used the "how long" answer correctly the moment he started asking it.** Cory said *"a few years, off and on, some years worse than others."* Muhammad: *"Since it's been going on for a while, I would strongly recommend TMCP."* That is your rule — *"if you've been fighting moles for a year, I'm not even going to tell you about the quick fix"* — executed on his second call ever.
- 3. He saved a price-shopper without being told how.** Cory: *"I got a couple other places I wanted to call."* Muhammad:

"Before you go, let me just tell you that we do only moles. We're not a pest control company. And the rate I mentioned, it's a flat rate. It's not per mole. Usually companies charge per mole. We don't. It doesn't matter if we catch two moles, five moles, or 100 — the price will be the same."

Cory: "That's good. No, definitely." — and asked for both quotes. That is a real closing instinct and it was entirely his own.

4. He walked through the disposal landmine clean. Asked whether moles are relocated or killed, on his second call, he gave the correct policy answer: pest-control bags into the customer's own trash can, taken along only on special request. Most new hires get that wrong in a way that costs a customer.

5. He offered the photo ID to a caller who wasn't sure he had moles. Correct, and it wasn't prompted.

The one real gap left

He has never delivered the education block. Not once, in either call.

That's it. That's the gap. Everything else on the list is small.

And in call #2 it cost something visible. Cory told him "*a few years, off and on, some years worse than others*" — that is the single best setup for "not if, but when" in the whole pack. Muhammad recommended the annual program correctly, but gave **no reason for it**. So the caller heard a naked \$100/month with nothing behind it, and did what anyone does with an unexplained number: went to price-shop.

He recovered it with the flat-rate save. But he shouldn't have needed to. The education block is what stops that call from ever getting to "let me call around."

Scorecards, both calls

Dimension	Call #1	Call #2	Movement
Accuracy (30)	20	22	Disposal, no-poison, flat-rate all correct in #2
Script arc (20)	13	14	Asked all three qualifiers — but still <i>after</i> quoting
Education & objections (20)	13	8	No block either time; #2 had less education, better objection work
Capture (15)	3	12	The big jump
Tone (15)	14	14	Consistent
Total	63 (<i>capped 60</i>)	70	

Call #1's cap came from guessing a mole fact ("tunnels are hundreds of miles"). **No hard gate tripped in call #2.**

The plan — six sessions, 20 minutes each

Run these with him live. One per day. Don't move on until the pass bar is met — but expect him to clear most of these in one sitting.

Session 1 — The education block, out loud (the only urgent one)

Goal: he can say all five beats cold, in order, without a prompt, in under 90 seconds.

How to run it:

1. Send him the 5-beat card. Have him read it out loud to you once, off the page.
2. Then take the page away and have him do it again. It will be rough. That's expected.
3. Third time, you play a caller who has just re-sodded their lawn. He runs the block unprompted, before you've asked anything.
4. Then run it once where **you interrupt him in the middle** — because real callers do. The point is he picks up where he left off instead of abandoning the block.

What to tell him up front: *"This isn't new information — you already know all of it, you proved that on both calls. What's new is saying it in one go, before I ask you for it."* That framing matters. He's not learning moles, he's learning delivery.

Pass bar: all five beats, in order, no page, no prompting, twice in a row.

Session 2 — Nothing gets priced until you've qualified

Goal: location → acreage → residential/commercial → how long, *then* the block, *then* the price. Every time.

The specific problem: in call #2 he quoted \$100/month and *then* asked where the property was and how big. He got lucky — Cory was exactly one acre residential. If Cory had said three acres, he'd have had to walk his own price backwards, which is the single worst thing you can do to trust on a first call.

He knows this. He even said out loud *"because the price that I quoted is for one acre and residential, so it's good to go"* — he caught the risk after the fact. Now move the catch to before.

How to run it: four short calls in a row, and you open each one by demanding a price immediately — *"just tell me what it costs."* His job is to answer *"I'll give you an exact number in about a minute, let me just get a couple of things first"* and hold it.

Pass bar: four calls, zero numbers before all four qualifiers are in.

Session 3 — The full price sheet, and the guarantee he keeps forgetting

Goal: both options priced at all three tiers, plus the no-catch guarantee, said without hesitation.

The gap: he has not said the guarantee once in two calls. *"If we don't catch any moles and the problem goes away on its own, all you pay is the \$150 setup fee"* — that's one of your three closing reassurances and it's

the thing that makes a stranger comfortable paying up front. In call #2 he reached for something adjacent (*"if it's not moles, you wouldn't have to pay the whole amount"*) which muddles the guarantee with the not-moles refund. Two different things.

He also never quoted the quick fix at all in call #2 — described it, never priced it.

Drill: you call out a property, he fires back both options fully priced with the guarantee attached. "Two acres, residential." "Half acre, residential." "Four acres." "Commercial, ten acres." (That last one — he should refuse to quote and route it to Cory for an in-person bid.)

Pass bar: ten in a row, no hesitation, guarantee attached every time.

Session 4 — Address and date discipline

Goal: he never confirms an address he hasn't read back, and never names a day he hasn't checked.

Two real slips:

- In call #2 he read the address back as "11211" when Cory had said "263 S C Street." Cory corrected him. A real customer often doesn't — they just don't get a visit. This is the same failure that already burned us once when the AI confirmed "3302 Bond Road" to a caller saying "302."
- Both calls he promised timing he hadn't checked — *"today or tomorrow"* and *"same day or the next day."*

The habit: read the full address back, slowly, and wait for a yes. Then pull the address lookup before naming any day. Your version is *"I want to say Thursday, but let me make sure"* — then actually look.

Pass bar: five calls, address read back verbatim every time, no day named without the lookup open.

Session 5 — Objection reps (sharpening, not fixing)

He already has instincts here. This session is about giving him three more tools, not repairing anything.

He already owns:

- *"If you call us three times a year, it costs you more than the plan."*
- The flat-rate / we-only-do-moles save.

Add:

They say	He says
"I'll do the one month and see how you do"	"Totally fair, a lot of people start there. The one month proves we can catch them — it just doesn't stop the next one moving into that territory. Four calls a year is \$1,800. The program is \$1,200 and we never leave."
"Do they go away in winter?"	"They don't go away, we just stop seeing them. When it rains everywhere their existing tunnels produce enough worms, so they don't dig new ones, so no new hills. It's a visibility thing. We catch moles year round on about a thousand properties."
"How many moles do I have?"	"Probably one or two — they're territorial. But that's also why the next one moves in when we take this one out."

Pass bar: all three delivered without reaching for notes.

Session 6 — Live fire

Put him on real calls with you listening. Not role-play — actual leads.

He's ready for this sooner than the scores imply. His tone is already better than most people get to in a month, and his instinct under pressure is sound. What he needs now is volume, and the only thing that gets him volume is real calls.

Your job on these: don't interrupt. Take notes. Debrief after. The one thing worth stopping a call for is a wrong price or a promised date.

What to say to him

He's just done his first two mole calls in his life and got a 63 and a 70, with a self-correction in between that most people need to be told about twice. Lead with that.

Then give him the one thing:

"Everything you're missing is one 60-second speech. You already know all of it — you proved that on both calls. You're just answering with it instead of leading with it. Lead with it and you won't have to defend a price again."

Next role-play

Scenario 2 (dog/kids/traps) and scenario 6 (the DIY veteran). One rule: **the block, unprompted, before any number.** Grade the block first and everything else second.